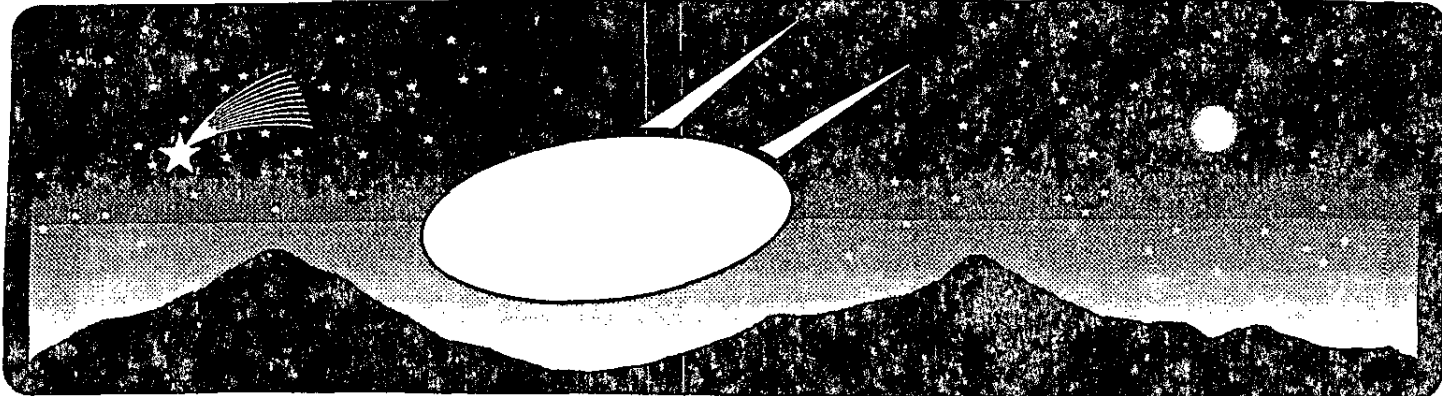


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SKYWATCH

The Encounters Report

May/June 1996-Volume Three, Number Two-\$3 USA, \$4 Canada
SKYWATCH is a bi-monthly collective work of the United States UFO Information and Research Center



FOREWORD

By Stacey A. McGee
Founder and National Director
UNITED STATES UFO INFORMATION
AND RESEARCH CENTER

Hello everyone! Inside this edition of Skywatch: The Encounters Report you'll find "Ten Things You Should Do if You Encounter a UFO," by Michael G. Curta, Quotes from American Astronauts found on the Internet, and several new local area and regional sighting reports as well as some close encounter stories given to us to be released here by the contactees for the first time ever in print. We sincerely hope that every issue of Skywatch will be better and better in providing each of you with the latest information and developments in the realm of the UFO phenomenon.

Current Events include a recent front page article about the Center and our future plans and goals, new UFO paraphernalia offered from vendors through the Center, and an upcoming article to be circulated from coast to coast in the National Associated Press News and will go to every major news publishing and broadcasting company in the United States. It will feature our Research Center and its mission and some local encounters as well as information about our upcoming EXPO.

We need everyone to send in there registration forms and fees as soon as possible for the conference. I am extending the \$10 discount to anyone who writes, or calls the Center with there registration before June 15, 1996. So HURRY, you don't want to miss out on this exciting event. For more information, please see the back page of this newsletter.

Ten Things You Should Do if You Encounter a UFO

By Michael G. Curta

Every year over 70,000 reports of UFO sightings come into UFO Research Organizations around the world. While it is true that 9 out of

10 sightings are explainable (possibly more), it is also true that only 1 in 10 is ever reported and each year the number of reports increase. Is this because there are more sightings? Is it because more people are willing to come forward and report their sightings to researchers? Or could it simply be that in the past witnesses did not know where to report sightings. What ever the case may be and you could make a case for all 3, the fact still remains that the number of reports are going up at an incredible rate.

There are far more reports than investigators and that is where the witnesses must help the investigator. Think of the sighting like a crime! Though the only crime being committed is the one our government commits by its unwillingness to openly investigate such sightings. I say think of it as a crime because you never know what is going to happen and you need to remember exact details of the event for recall at a later time. The information that follows is designed to help you to help investigators:

1. Remain Calm! Protect yourself from hazards real or perceived. Be prepared to take evasive (but not aggressive) action to get out of its way. Remember you might be witnessing the event of a life time and will want to remember every detail and you can't do that if you are hysterical.

2. Be objective. Not every UFO is extraterrestrial, eliminate every other possibility (within your means) first. Only after that should you consider the possibility that what you saw might be a true UFO.

3. Use a camcorder or camera to record the event. Try to keep reference points in the field of view, as this will aid researchers in analyzing the film. If you do not have a camera or camcorder then draw pictures of what you saw

People Helping People to Find the Truth...

and the area around it.

4. If you have a tape recorder, record your description of the event as it happens. Include reference points on this tape also. For example..."I am about 10 yards from the big oak tree and the craft is 30 yards beyond that". If you don't have a tape recorder write down your observations right after the event.

5. If other witnesses are present ask them to also write or record their observations but do NOT discuss the event with them (at least until after your observations have been recorded) as investigators want to know what you saw not what your neighbor saw.

6. If the UFO left some trace of its presence behind do not disturb the area around it and restrict access to the site (its not a crime any more, its now a crime scene). Photograph the area around the site before you enter the area and make notes of the exact position of every thing! Take close up photos or video tape of the evidence before touching it. Remember you don't know what your touching, where it came from, or what type of hazards might be associated with it!

7. If the sighting is from a distance, at an arms length, what would it take to cover up the object? A quarter? A penny? A dime? An asprin? Or would it take something bigger? A golf ball? A baseball, or a tennis ball?

8. Try to judge the distance from you to the object, the object's altitude, and its speed. Was it across the street or was it over the next field? Was it tree top level or was it a few hundred feet up? Did it cross the sky in 5 seconds or 5 minutes?

9. Should you encounter some type of extraterrestrial being associated with the craft be prepared to take evasive action to protect yourself. From a safe distance, in a concealed position photograph or video tape the being. If you are unable to safely get photos of the being, draw and write down a description as soon as it is safe to do so.

10. Immediately report the event to a UFO research organization. There are several such organizations around the world. The United States UFO Information and Research Center is the third largest networking operation in the world an it is still growing. They currently have over 2,300 members worldwide and represent 50 states and 18 different countries.

You can report your sighting or encounter with alien beings confidentially to the Center by calling their 24 hour Sightings and Information Hotline: (423) 743-2100, or fax to (423) 743-2115.

UFO Sightings By Astronauts

Major Gordon Cooper

One of the original Mercury Astronauts and the last American to fly in space alone. On May 15, 1963 he shot into space in a Mercury capsule for a 22 orbit journey around the world. During the final orbit, Major Gordon Cooper told the tracking station at Muchea (near Perth, Australia) that he could see a glowing, greenish object ahead of him quickly approaching his capsule. The UFO was real and solid, because it was picked up by Muchea's tracking radar.

Cooper's sighting was reported by the National Broadcast Company, which was covering the flight step by step; but when Cooper landed, reporters were told that they would not be allowed to question him about the UFO sighting.

Major Cooper was a firm believer in UFOs. Ten years earlier, in 1951 he had sighted a UFO while piloting an F-86 Sabrejet over Western Germany. They were metallic, saucer-shaped discs at considerable altitude and could out maneuver all American fighter planes.

Major Cooper also testified before the United Nations:

"I believe that these extraterrestrial vehicles and their crews are visiting this planet from other planets... Most astronauts were reluctant to discuss UFOs."

"I did have occasion in 1951 to have two days of observation of many flights of them, of different sizes, flying in fighter formation, generally from east to west over Europe."

And according to a taped interview by J.L. Ferrando, Major Cooper said:

"For many years I have lived with a secret, in a secrecy imposed on all specialists in astronautics. I can now reveal that every day in the USA, our radar instruments capture objects of form and composition unknown to us. And there are thousands of witness reports and a quantity of documents to prove this, but nobody wants to make them public."

"Why? Because authority is afraid that people may think of God knows what kind of horrible invaders. So the password still is: We have to avoid panic by all means."

"I was furthermore a witness to an extraordinary phenomenon, here on this planet. It happened a few months ago in Florida. There I saw with my own eyes a defined area of ground being consumed by flames, with four indentions left by a flying object which had descended in the middle of a field. Beings had left the craft (there were other traces to prove this). They seemed to have studied topography, they had collected soil samples and, eventually, they returned to where they had come from, disappearing at enormous speed...I happen to know that authority did just about everything to keep this incident from the press and TV, in fear of a panicky reaction from the public."

Ed White and James McDivitt

In June 1965, astronauts Ed White (first American to walk in space) and James McDivitt were passing over Hawaii in a Gemini spacecraft when they saw a weird-looking metallic object. The UFO had long arms sticking out of it. McDivitt took pictures with a cine-camera. Those pictures have never been released.

James Lovell and Frank Borman

In December 1965, Gemini astronauts James Lovell and Frank Borman also saw a UFO during the second orbit of their record-breaking 14 day flight. Borman reported that he saw an unidentified spacecraft some distance from their capsule. Gemini Control, at Cape Kennedy told him that he was seeing the final stage of their own Titan Booster rocket. Borman confirmed that he could see the booster rocket all right, but that he could also see something completely different.

During James Lovell's flight on Gemini 7: (Lovell in CAPS and capcom in lower case.)

"BOGEY AT 10 O'CLOCK HIGH."

"This is Houston. Say again 7."

"SAID WE HAVE A BOGEY AT 10 O'CLOCK HIGH."

"Gemini 7, is that the booster or is that an actual sighting?"

"WE HAVE SEVERAL...ACTUAL SIGHTING."

"...Estimated distance or size?"

"WE ALSO HAVE THE BOOSTER IN SIGHT..."

Neil Armstrong & Edwin "Buzz" Aldrin

According to NASA astronaut Neil Armstrong the aliens have a base on the Moon and told us in no uncertain terms to get off and stay off the Moon.

According to hitherto unconfirmed reports, both Neil Armstrong and Edwin "Buzz" Aldrin saw UFOs shortly after that historic landing on the Moon in Apollo 11 on July 21, 1969. I remember hearing one of the astronauts refer to a "light" in or on a crater during the television transmission, followed by a request from mission control for further information. Nothing more was heard.

According to former NASA employee Otto Binder, unnamed radio hams with their own VHF receiving facilities that bypassed NASA's broadcasting outlets picked up the following exchange:

NASA "What's there?"

"...mission control calling Apollo 11..."

Steve - if you don't have these quotes, I thought you'd want to know.

Apollo 11-"These "babies" are huge, Sir! Enormous!...OH MY GOD! You wouldn't believe it! I'm telling you there are other spacecraft out there, lined up on the far side of the crater edge! They're on the Moon watching us!"

A certain professor, who wished to remain anonymous, was engaged in a discussion with Neil Armstrong during a NASA symposium. Their conversation went like this:

"What REALLY happened out there with Apollo 11?"

Armstrong-"It was incredible, of course we had always known there was a possibility, the fact is, we were warned off! (by the aliens). There was never any question then of a space station or a moon city."

"How do you mean "warned off"?"

Armstrong-"I can't go into details, except to say that their ships were far superior to ours both in size and technology-Boy, were they big!...and menacing! No, there is no question of a space station."

"But NASA had other missions after Apollo 11?"

Armstrong-"Naturally-NASA was committed at that time, and couldn't risk panic on Earth. But it really was a quick scoop and back again."

According to a Dr. Vladimir Azhazha:

"Neil Armstrong relayed the message to Mission Control that two large, mysterious objects were watching them after having landed near the moon module. But this message was never heard by the public--because NASA censored it."

According to Dr. Aleksandr Kasantsev, Buzz Aldrin took color movie films of the UFOs from inside the module, and continued filming them after he and Armstrong went outside.

Armstrong confirmed that the story was true but refused to go into further detail, beyond admitting that the CIA was behind the coverup.

Donald Slayton

Donald Slayton, a Mercury astronaut, revealed in an interview he had seen UFOs in 1951:

"I was testing a P-51 fighter in Minneapolis when I spotted this object. I was at about 10,000 feet on a nice, bright, sunny afternoon. I thought the object was a kite, then I realized that no kite is gonna fly that high."

"As I got closer it looked like a weather balloon, gray and about three feet in diameter. But as soon as I got behind the darn thing it didn't look like a balloon anymore. It looked like a saucer, a disk."

"About that same time, I realized that it was suddenly going away from me--and there I was, running at about 300 miles per hour. I tracked it for a little way, and then all of a sudden the darn thing just took off. It pulled about a 45° climbing turn and accelerated and just flat disappeared."

Major Robert White

On July 17, 1962 Major Robert White reported a UFO during his fifty-eight mile high flight of an X-15:

"I have no idea what it could be. It was grayish in color and about thirty to forty feet away."

Then according to a Time Magazine article, Major White exclaimed over the radio:

"There ARE things out there! There absolutely is!"

NASA Pilot Joseph A. Walker

On May 11, 1962 NASA pilot Joseph Walker said that one of his tasks was to detect UFOs during his X-15 flights. He had filmed five or six UFOs during his record-breaking fifty-mile-high flight in April, 1962. It was the second time he had filmed UFOs in flight. During a lecture at the second national conference on the peaceful uses of space research in Seattle, Washington he said:

"I don't feel like speculating about them. All I know is what appeared on the film which was developed after the flight."

To date none of those films have been released to the public for viewing.

Comander Eugene Cernan

Eugene Cernan was commander of Apollo 17. In a

Los Angeles Times article in 1973 he said, about UFOs:

"...I've been asked (about UFOs) and I've said publicly I thought they (UFOs) were somebody else, some other civilization."

NASA's Maurice Chatelain

In 1979 Maurice Chatelain, former chief of NASA Communications Systems confirmed that Armstrong had indeed reported seeing two UFOs on the rim of a crater. Chatelain believes that some UFOs may come from our own solar system--specifically Titan.

"The encounter was common knowledge in NASA, but nobody has talked about it until now."

"...all Apollo and Gemini flights were followed, both at a distance and sometimes also quite closely, by space vehicles of extraterrestrial origin-flying saucers, or UFOs, if you want to call them by that name. Every time it occurred, the astronauts informed Mission Control, who then ordered absolute silence."

"I think that Walter Schirra, aboard Mercury 8, was the first of the astronauts to use the code name 'Santa Claus' to indicate the presence of flying saucers next to space capsules. However, this announcements were barely noticed by the general public. It was a little different when James Lovell on board the Apollo 8 command module came out from behind the moon and said for everybody to hear: 'PLEASE BE INFORMED THAT THERE IS A SANTA CLAUS.' Even though this happened on Christmas Day 1968, many people sensed a hidden meaning in those words."

The rumors persist. NASA may well be a civilian agency, but many of its programs are funded by the defense budget and most of the astronauts are subject to military security regulations. Apart from the fact that the National Security Agency screens all films and probably radio communications as well. We have the statements by Otto Binder, Dr. Garry Henderson and Maurice Chatelain that the astronauts were under strict orders not to discuss their sightings and Gordon Cooper has testified to a United Nations committee that one of the astronauts actually witnessed a UFO on the ground. If there is no secrecy, why has this sighting not been made public?

NASA's Scott Carpenter

"At no time when the astronauts were in space were they alone: There was a constant surveillance by UFOs."

Sources: Great Mysteries: UFOs by Robert Jackson / Above Top Secret by Timothy Good / The UFO Encyclopedia by John Spencer / Genesis Revisited by Zacharia Setchin.

Upcoming Network Events

You are Invited

Saturday, May 11-Is the date that our May Skywatch has fallen upon. Those interested in attending are encourage to meet us under the Wal-Mart sign in Greeneville, Tennessee at 8 PM just off of highway 11-E, which is the by-pass going through Greeneville. The Wal-Mart is located on the North side of Greeneville on the By-Pass. Everyone is invited. Come and join us for a wonderful time under the night sky looking for UFOs.

Sunday, May 19-There will be an international on-line conference with the United States UFO Information and Research Center and it's upcoming Int'l Symposium as the topics of discussion at 7 PM on Compuserve. For

Great Smoky Mountains UFO, Crop Circle and Alien Contact EXPO

an International Symposium
to be held in famous Gatlinburg, Tennessee-
Gateway to the Smokies- Saturday, August 10, 1996

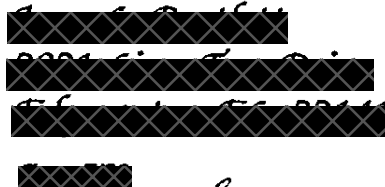
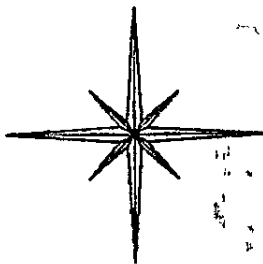
There will be talks and workshops by well known speakers and authors. Passes to EXPO workshops, EXPO T-Shirts, regional newsletters, and many UFO books, videos and audio tapes will be on display and available to purchase. The EXPO will be presented at the Gatlinburg Convention Center from 9 AM to 9 PM. Our confirmed, honored speakers include Mike Rogers and Travis Walton author of *Fire in the Sky*, *The Walton Experience*, Dr. John Hunter Gray from the Department of Indian Studies at the University of North Dakota, Peter Geromia of New Hampshire Mutual UFO Network, and Michelle LaVigne, editor of *Contact Forum* published by Wild Flower Press and author of *The Alien Abduction Survival Guide*, with special tribute to Mrs. Betty Hill, retired UFO and abduction researcher.

This will be the third annual conference and the first international symposium sponsored by the UNITED STATES UFO INFORMATION AND RESEARCH CENTER in Johnson City, Tennessee. Tickets are \$35 per person if purchased before June 15, 1996, or \$45 per person thereafter. No tickets will be sold at the door. ADVANCE TICKETS ARE A MUST!!!

Call (423) 743-2100 for more information

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and Research Center
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THE TRUTH IS OUT THERE